

Hermes

NOUS RESEARCH

AGENTIC

“Not just a model — a self-improving open-source agent that builds and refines its own skills as it works.”

BEST FOR

- Autonomous agents that run long, multi-step jobs unattended
- Function calling and reliable tool-use across 20+ platforms
- Persistent memory and a learning loop that improves with use
- Agent-to-agent communication for multi-agent systems
- Privacy-first, self-hosted automation (fully open-source, MIT license)

NOT BEST FOR

- Not a simple chat app — expect some technical setup
- Best results require pairing it with an underlying LLM you provide
- Younger ecosystem than the major consumer assistants

GETTING STARTED

- Go to hermes-agent.org or the NousResearch/hermes-agent repo on GitHub.
- Install Hermes Desktop (Mac, Windows, or Linux) for a native GUI — no CLI required.
- Or spin up a hosted instance on Nous Portal Cloud, billed hourly from credits.
- Connect your model provider (or a local model) and your first tools/skills.

PRICING

PLAN	PRICE	NOTES
Self-hosted	Free (MIT license)	Full control; your own compute + model cost
Hermes Desktop	Free	Native GUI app for Mac, Windows, Linux
Nous Portal Cloud	Pay-as-you-go	Hosted instances billed hourly from credits
Underlying model cost	Varies	Pair with Claude, GPT, Llama, or a local model

KEY FEATURES

- v0.20.0 “The Herald Release” (Aug 2026): real-time voice with streaming text-to-speech
- Agent-to-agent communication (A2A v1.0) for multi-agent workflows
- Signed outbound webhooks and grounded research with verifiable citations
- Learning loop: creates, tests, and refines its own skills from experience
- Fully open-source under the MIT license, runs on 20+ platforms

PROMPT TEMPLATES

“Build me a skill that checks our inbox every morning and drafts replies to routine questions.”

“Monitor this webpage/RSS feed and alert me by webhook when [condition] happens.”

“Research [topic] and produce a cited brief, then save it to my notes.”

“Coordinate with [another agent] to handle intake, then hand off qualified leads to me.”

QUICK REFERENCE

Get a GUI, no terminal	Install Hermes Desktop
Skip the setup entirely	Use a hosted instance on Nous Portal Cloud
Give it a new capability	Ask it to build/refine a skill — it learns from use
Connect two agents	Use A2A v1.0 messaging
Get talked to, not just texted	Use real-time voice mode

PRO TIPS

- Start with Hermes Desktop before touching the CLI — it covers most day-to-day use.
- Let the learning loop run for a week before judging it; skills improve with repeated use.
- Pair it with a cheaper model for routine tasks and a stronger one for anything high-stakes.
- Review signed webhooks and permissions before connecting it to anything business-critical.